

Lesson 04

Describing your organization



Role-Play

Read the conversation between Mike and Meg.

Mike: Hi Meg, do you have a minute? I'm still trying to get my head around the **company** structure here.

Meg: Sure, Mike. It can be a bit complex at first. What are you finding confusing?

Mike: Well, I understand we're a **subsidiary** of a larger international group, but how does that affect our day-to-day work?

Meg: Right. So, we have a lot of autonomy, but certain decisions go to the **corporate** level. For example, major financial approvals.

Mike: Okay, and what about the different **divisions**? I'm in Marketing, but I'm not sure how we connect with Sales.

Meg: We work closely with them. Each division has a **Head of** department, and they coordinate regularly. Our **reporting structure** is quite clear. You report to your **Team Leader**, then they report to the Head of Marketing, and so on.

Mike: That makes sense. Speaking of Team Leaders, I like mine. They are very supportive. What about the overall **company culture** here?

Meg: It's pretty good. We try to foster a collaborative environment. Everyone is encouraged to share ideas, and there are regular team-building events.

Mike: That's great to hear. I was a little worried about the size of the company, but it seems well-organized.

Meg: Yes, it is. The clear reporting structure and defined divisions help everyone understand their roles and responsibilities.

Mike: Thanks, Meg. This has really cleared things up.

Meg: No problem, Mike. If you have any other questions, just ask.

Think-Pair-Share QUESTIONS:

1. Who does Mike's 'Team Leader' report to, according to Meg?
2. What part of the company makes big financial decisions, the 'subsidiary' or the 'corporate' group?
3. How does Meg describe the 'company culture' and teamwork?
4. What are the two 'divisions' mentioned by Meg, and how do they work together?
5. Who is in charge of each 'division' according to Meg?
6. Now, using the same words, how would you describe the organization you work for, or a company you know well?



Grammar

1. Simple Present Tense

Use: Describe facts, routines, and processes

Example: *"Our company has five divisions: Sales, IT, HR, marketing, and Finance."*

2. Passive Voice

Use: Emphasize processes and results instead of the performer.

Structure: [Object]+is/ re + past participle

Example: *"The company is structured into different departments."*

3. Relative Clauses for Describing Roles and Departments

Use: Provide extra details about IT roles, processes, or systems

Example: *"The security update, which was released last week, fixed major bugs."*

4. Complex Sentences for Professionalism

Use: connect multiple ideas logically in emails, reports, and presentations

Example: *"Although the new system is faster, some employees prefer the old one."*

5. Conjunctions (e.g., because, although, since): improve clarity in explanations.



Practice

A. Fill in the blanks with the correct words or phrases from the lesson.

1. The ____ of our IT department is responsible for overseeing all software development projects.
2. Our company operates as ____ of a multinational corporation.
3. The ____ consists of different departments such as Finance, Marketing, and IT.
4. In our organization, the ____ ensures that employees know whom to report to.
5. The ____ leads a small group of developers within the IT Department.
6. Our headquarters is ____ in Vietnam, but we have offices worldwide.
7. The company's values and working environment are part of its ____.
8. The HR Department, ____ (who/which/that) handles recruitment, reports directly to the CEO. *(Use a relative clause.)*
9. The finance team ____ (handle) budgeting and payroll for the entire company. *(Use present simple.)*
10. The company has a flexible work policy, ____ allows employees to work remotely. *(Use a complex sentence.)*

WORD BANK:

head of	team leader	corporate division	subsidiary
locate	headquarters	reporting structure	company culture



Production

TASK: Create a script for a 2-minute presentation of the hierarchical structure of your company using the guide under vocabulary reinforcement part of this lesson.

Role playing: LIVE PRESENTATION OF THE HIERARCHICAL STRUCTURE OF A COMPANY (using the script prepared under Practice Task)

CRITERIA:

Fluency	5
Pronunciation	5
Grammar & Accuracy	5
Use of Key Vocabulary	5
Confidence & Engagement	5
TOTAL:	25 points

5 – Excellent 4 – Very Good 3 – Good 2 – Satisfactory 1 – Not Evident/Observed



Key Vocabulary

Word/Phrase	Use	Example
Company Culture	The values and behaviors of such a company	<i>"Our company culture values innovation."</i>
Corporate Division	A major section within a company	<i>"We operate as a subsidiary of Soft Tech."</i>
Head of	Refers to someone leading a department	<i>"She is the head of Marketing."</i>
Reporting Structure	Defines how roles report to each other	<i>"Our reporting structure is hierarchical."</i>
Subsidiary	A company controlled by a larger family	<i>"We operate as a subsidiary of Soft Tech."</i>
Team Leader	Leads a specific team within a division	<i>"The team leader assigns tasks."</i>

Vocabulary Reinforcement/Guide

Presentation Structure:

1. Introduction & Company Overview:
2. Corporate Divisions & Subsidiaries:
3. Reporting Structure -Key Personnel:
4. Team/Department Deep Dive (Focus on IT):
5. Company Culture & Collaboration
6. Q&A and Wrap-Up



Summary

- Companies have structured hierarchies with key roles such as CEO, managers, Team Leaders, and Departments.
- Each level has distinct responsibilities that contribute to business operations and efficiency.
- Practice explaining a company's hierarchy in discussions and presentations to improve fluency and confidence.
- A well-structured explanation of a company's organization builds credibility and professionalism.



Homework

Task: Record an audio clip/voice explaining the hierarchical structure of your company.
(may be via <https://vocaroo.com>) - Record-Save-Share

Instructions:

1. Introduce your company briefly.
2. Describe the key departments and their functions.
3. Explain the reporting structure (who reports to whom).
4. Mention something about the company culture.
5. Use at least three vocabulary words from the lesson.
6. Use at least one relative clause.
7. Keep it concise (5-7 sentences) and engaging)